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is expanding in India with 1,200 new hires at its Mumbai and Gurugram hubs focusing on AI-driven investment research, risk management and financial analytics.

Carl Zeiss, a German optics and optoelectronics company, has also opened a GCC in Bengaluru to enhance its digital transformation and research initiatives. The unit will focus on cloud computing, cyber security and network operations while advancing software solutions for Carl Zeiss Meditec

Nasscom-Zinnov report. Nishith Desai Associates, in its latest report on GCCs, says the reasons global companies prefer India for GCCs are economic resilience, political stability, government initiatives, and cost-effective infrastructure and workforce. “The country’s consistent economic growth, despite the global challenges posed by the Covid-19 pandemic, has enhanced India’s reputation as a reliable and stable business hub. The Indian government’s incen-

PROGRESSIVE REGULATORY REFORMS ENSURED GLOBAL COMPETITIVENESS, FOSTERING A BUSINESS-FRIENDLY ENVIRONMENT

della announced a record \$3 billion investment in India to expand Azure Cloud, AI infrastructure and skilling initiatives, solidifying the company’s digital leadership. On the other hand, Cisco’s Bangalore GCC is its largest development centre outside the US and houses over 15,000 employees working on AI-driven networking, cybersecurity and 5G infrastructure.

According to Inductus GCC, a remarkable 124 top-tier global enterprises entered into agreements to establish GCCs between 2023 and 2024, securing prime office spaces for the development of advanced greenfield operations and research and development hubs. One of the companies on the list is BlackRock Inc., one of the largest asset management companies in the world. It

AG’s medical technology division. French multinational pharmaceutical and healthcare firm Sanofi is also expanding its GCC in Hyderabad with a €400-million investment over six years, including €100 million by 2025. The hub will grow to 2,600 employees, making it the largest of Sanofi’s four global centres.

Dawber of Novo Nordisk says the “employees come from both pharma and non-pharma backgrounds, including doctors, pharmacists, PhDs, statisticians, commercial experts, marketers, analysts, finance professionals, IT engineers and architects.”

What makes India a preferred destination for GCCs? Around 70% of the top 500 companies by revenue are expected to expand presence in India by 2030, as per the

tives are aimed at increasing the ease of doing business, upskilling the young demographic and easing taxation policies, creating a favourable environment for GCCs,” says the global legal and tax counselling firm. It adds the country offers affordable and reliable internet and communication services, ensuring seamless operations at a fraction of the cost in other countries. In Mumbai and Bengaluru, per employee costs are \$33,570 and \$33,083 per annum, respectively. The same is \$134,400 per annum in USA and \$63,416 in Manila, as per a Cushman & Wakefield report published in 2024.

GROWTH DRIVERS

Experts say regulatory reforms have also enhanced India’s competitiveness, fostering a business-